

REGIONAL CONSORTIUM CHARTER

East & Southern Africa Ocean Resilience Alliance (ESA-ORA)

Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH), Climate Action, Public Health, and Sustainable Blue Economy

Participating Countries: Kenya, Tanzania, Mozambique, Madagascar

Founding Organizations:



Name	Country of Registration	Representative Name and Position	Signature

1 Consortium Vision



The Consortium envisions a resilient and environmentally sustainable East and Southern African region in which communities have equitable access to safe water, adequate sanitation, and strengthened public health systems. Coastal and marine ecosystems are managed responsibly to support sustainable livelihoods and thriving blue economies. Through collaborative regional action, the Consortium aims to strengthen environmental stewardship, enhance climate resilience, and promote inclusive economic opportunities that benefit present and future generations.

2. Consortium Mission

The Consortium seeks to establish a collaborative regional platform that unites organizations working in water security, climate resilience, public health, and sustainable ocean economies. Through strategic partnerships, joint programming, research, and innovation, the Consortium will mobilize technical and financial resources to support sustainable development initiatives and improve the well-being of communities across participating countries.

3. Strategic Objectives

The Consortium's strategic objectives are:

- Strengthen equitable access to safe and sustainable water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH) services by supporting community-centred infrastructure development, rehabilitation of water supply systems, improved sanitation facilities, and comprehensive hygiene promotion initiatives. The Consortium will prioritize climate-resilient WASH solutions that enhance long-term sustainability, reduce vulnerability to climate impacts, and improve living conditions in underserved and coastal communities.
- Advance climate adaptation and environmental resilience through ecosystem restoration, nature-based solutions, and climate-resilient resource management practices. The Consortium will promote initiatives such as mangrove restoration, watershed protection, coastal ecosystem rehabilitation, and climate risk assessments, complemented by collaborative regional research to support evidence-based planning, policy development, and sustainable environmental stewardship.
- Promote sustainable blue economy development by supporting responsible fisheries management, marine conservation, circular economy approaches, and ocean-based entrepreneurship. This includes strengthening value chains and sustainable enterprises related to fisheries, seaweed cultivation, mangrove restoration, eco-tourism, and other marine and coastal resources, with particular emphasis on youth and women-led enterprises that generate sustainable livelihoods while protecting marine biodiversity.
- Improve public health outcomes and community wellbeing through integrated WASH and community health programs. The Consortium will support health education, disease prevention initiatives, sanitation and hygiene awareness campaigns, and collaboration with local health systems to address waterborne diseases, strengthen maternal and child health awareness, and promote healthier living environments.
- Foster regional knowledge exchange, collaborative research, and innovation by creating platforms that facilitate cross-country learning, technical cooperation, and joint research initiatives among participating organizations, academic institutions, and communities. These efforts will generate evidence-based solutions, inform policy and practice, and strengthen the exchange of best practices and cultural experiences across the region.
- Strengthen capacity building and technical training programs for community members, partner organizations, and local institutions through workshops, technical exchanges, mentorship programs, and knowledge-sharing platforms. These initiatives will enhance local capacities in climate adaptation, sustainable natural resource management, environmental conservation, circular economy practices, and entrepreneurship within the blue economy sector.
- Monitor environmental impact and program performance through the establishment of robust monitoring, evaluation, and learning systems. The Consortium will implement data-driven environmental monitoring mechanisms to track ecosystem health, measure program outcomes, assess social and environmental impact, and ensure transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement in all interventions.

- Mobilize financial and technical resources while strengthening institutional capacity to effectively implement regional initiatives. The Consortium will coordinate joint fundraising efforts, develop collaborative project proposals, and engage with development partners, philanthropic organizations, and climate finance institutions to secure sustainable funding and expand the scale and impact of regional programs.

4. Geographic Scope

The Consortium will primarily operate within Kenya, Tanzania, Mozambique, and Madagascar, which share interconnected coastal ecosystems and socio-economic challenges. Membership is open to other organizations and institutions from the region upon evaluation and approval by the Steering Committee, ensuring alignment with Consortium objectives and standards.

5. Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH)

The WASH pillar focuses on improving access to safe water, adequate sanitation, and hygiene practices, particularly in underserved and climate-vulnerable communities. Programs may include the construction and rehabilitation of water supply infrastructure, establishment of sanitation facilities, hygiene behaviour change campaigns, and institutional WASH programs within schools, healthcare facilities, and community centers. Climate-resilient solutions will be prioritized to ensure sustainability.

6. Climate Action and Environmental Resilience

Climate change represents a significant threat to ecosystems, livelihoods, and community health. Consortium initiatives will focus on climate adaptation, ecosystem restoration, mangrove rehabilitation, watershed protection, and other nature-based solutions. Activities may include climate risk assessments, early warning systems, and community adaptation planning aimed at enhancing resilience in coastal and inland communities.

7. Sustainable Blue Economy

The Consortium will promote sustainable ocean-based development while protecting marine ecosystems. Programs include marine conservation initiatives, sustainable fisheries and aquaculture development, and support for ocean-based entrepreneurship. Youth and women-led ventures, technology-driven marine monitoring, and circular economy initiatives will be encouraged to enhance livelihoods while safeguarding marine biodiversity.

8. Public Health and Community Wellbeing

The Consortium integrates public health interventions with environmental programs to enhance community wellbeing. Activities focus on preventing waterborne diseases, improving hygiene practices, strengthening health education, and providing emergency sanitation responses. Special attention is given to maternal and child health, training for community health workers, and community awareness campaigns.

9. Resource Mobilization

Consortium partners will collaborate to identify and secure funding from philanthropic foundations, climate finance mechanisms, impact investment platforms, and other funding sources. Joint project proposals will be developed under Secretariat coordination to ensure alignment with Consortium priorities, quality assurance, and compliance with donor requirements.

10. Financial Management

All funds mobilized will be managed according to sound accounting principles and regulatory requirements. Lead implementing partners may manage project-specific funds and reporting. Periodic financial audits will ensure transparency and accountability. Financial management systems will align with both organizational standards and donor compliance.

11. Procurement

Procurement will adhere to principles of transparency, fairness, and value for money, ensuring ethical standards. Project-specific procedures may be implemented to comply with donor requirements and organizational policies.

12. Risk Management

The Consortium will adopt proactive risk management strategies to identify, monitor, and mitigate operational, financial, environmental, and reputational risks. Risk assessments will be reviewed periodically by the Steering Committee, with mitigation strategies implemented as necessary.

13. Safeguarding and Ethical Conduct

All partners will adhere to strict safeguarding principles to protect children, vulnerable individuals, and community participants. The Consortium maintains zero tolerance for corruption, exploitation, harassment, or unethical conduct.

14. Gender Equality and Social Inclusion

Programs will promote gender equality, youth engagement, and inclusion of marginalized groups. Equitable participation in decision-making, leadership opportunities, and benefits from Consortium initiatives is mandatory.

15. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL)

A regional MEL framework will track performance, assess social and environmental impact, and support continuous learning. Findings will inform program design, strategic decision-making, and knowledge sharing among partners.

16. Governance Structure

The Consortium governance framework comprises a Steering Committee, a Secretariat, Country Lead Organizations, and Technical Working Groups, ensuring strategic oversight, operational coordination, and technical support.

17. Steering Committee

The Steering Committee, composed of one senior representative from each founding organization, serves as the highest decision-making body. Responsibilities include strategic

leadership, approval of work plans and budgets, oversight of financial management, dispute resolution, and review of membership applications. Meetings occur at least twice per year, with decisions by consensus or majority vote where necessary.

18. Consortium Secretariat

The Secretariat coordinates day-to-day operations, organizes Steering Committee meetings, maintains documentation, facilitates partner communication, supports program development, and consolidates monitoring and reporting. It also serves as the primary contact for external stakeholders.

19. Country Lead Organizations

Designated in each participating country, Country Leads coordinate national-level implementation, liaise with local partners, facilitate stakeholder consultations, and ensure alignment with regional strategies. They report programmatic and financial progress to the Secretariat and Steering Committee.

20. Technical Working Groups

Technical Working Groups provide specialized expertise in WASH, climate action, blue economy, public health, and research and innovation. They support program design, implementation guidance, and knowledge sharing, reporting to the Steering Committee via the Secretariat.

21. Membership Expansion

Membership is open to organizations and institutions demonstrating alignment with Consortium objectives and values. Applications are evaluated by the Steering Committee based on technical and financial capacity, with final approval granted by the Steering Committee.

22. Climate Finance and Blue Economy Investment Strategy

The Consortium will pursue climate finance and blue economy investment opportunities, including grants, blended finance, and impact investments. Investments will support ecosystem restoration, climate-resilient infrastructure, sustainable fisheries, aquaculture, marine conservation, and ocean-based entrepreneurship. All investments will adhere to principles of sustainability, social inclusion, financial accountability, and measurable impact.

23. Funding Distribution Framework

Funds will be allocated transparently and equitably based on program relevance, geographic coverage, and partner capacity. Lead implementing partners may manage project funds with oversight from the Steering Committee. Regular auditing, reporting, and contingency provisions for emergencies will ensure accountability and responsiveness.

24. Duration

This Memorandum of Understanding is valid for five (5) years from the date of signature and may be renewed upon mutual agreement of all Consortium partners.

